



Walking on water

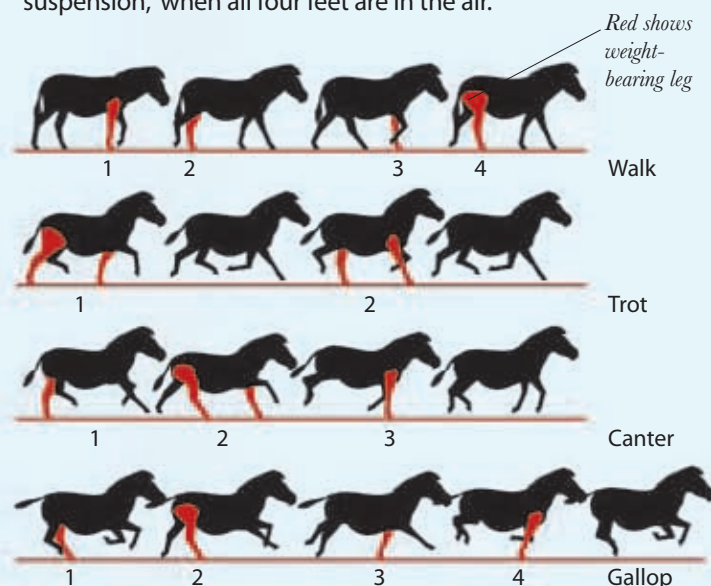
With its legs spread wide, the raft spider runs across the surface of ponds, homing in on flying insects that have crash-landed in the water. It has water-repellent hairs on the surface of its feet, which stop it from sinking through the water's surface. It is not the only animal that moves in this way—water striders also use the water's surface as a hunting ground.

Most of these little insects live on ponds and lakes, but in warm parts of the world, some even skate over the waves far out at sea.

Long tail acts as a counterweight, maintaining balance during sharp turns

Changing gaits

Hoofed mammals often use several different ways of moving, or gaits, which work like different gears. Zebras and their relatives have four natural gaits. Walking, the slowest, has a four-beat rhythm made by each leg landing one at a time. Trotting has two beats, with the legs moving in diagonal pairs. This is used to cover long distances efficiently. Canter is quicker, with three beats, while galloping, with four, is the fastest and is used to evade predators. Trot, canter, and gallop have periods of "suspension," when all four feet are in the air.



Paw has blunt, exposed claws that provide superior grip, increasing forward thrust